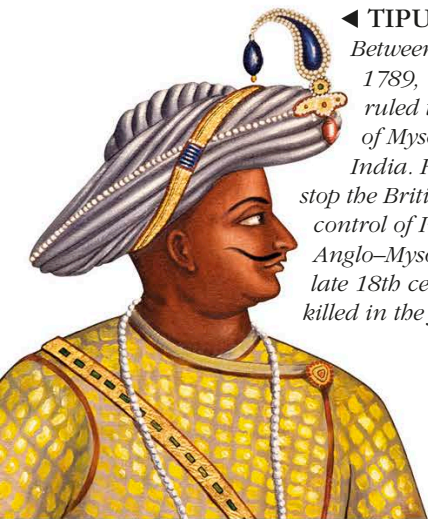
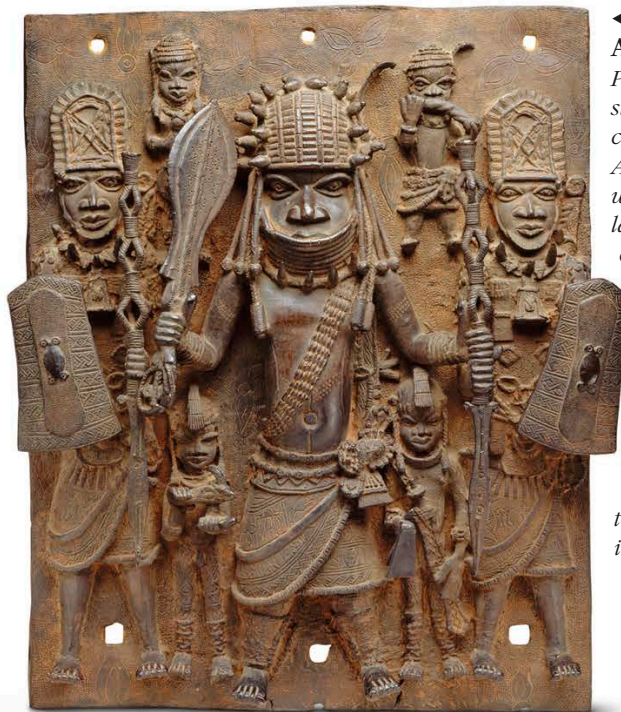




◀ TIPU SULTAN

Between 1782 and 1789, Tipu Sultan ruled the Kingdom of Mysore in south India. He fought to stop the British taking control of India in four Anglo-Mysore wars in the late 18th century. He was killed in the final battle.



◀ LOOTED ARTIFACTS

Priceless treasures were stolen when the British captured Benin in West Africa in 1897. Colonizers wanted control of the land—which is now part of Nigeria—for its oil and rubber, which were in high demand at the time. The “Benin Bronzes” have become symbols of colonialism, and there is a growing call for these looted artifacts to be returned to their rightful home in Nigeria.

▼ TRAIL OF TEARS

In 1830, as American settlers moved west, the Indian Removal Act allowed the government to forcibly remove Indigenous Americans from their lands in the southeast to “Indian Territory” west of the Mississippi River. Thousands died from illness and starvation on the journey, which became known as the Trail of Tears.



FACT

British colonists in Australia brought influenza, measles, and smallpox with them. First Australians had no resistance to these new diseases, and their populations fell dramatically.

THE COMMONWEALTH ▶

The Commonwealth is an organization of 54 countries—nearly all former territories of the British Empire—which was launched in 1949 after World War II. At that time, Europe’s empires had been weakened by years of fighting and countries began to call for independence.



TAKE A LOOK

During the worldwide Black Lives Matter protests in 2020, symbols of past colonialism were destroyed, including this statue of a 17th-century merchant and slave-trader that stood in Bristol, England.

